

## ● UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.11

# Fare Calculation Tools: ATPCO

*The data hub behind almost every airfare you see.*

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 2: Fare Construction Principles  
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar

**AIR TICKETING ACADEMY**

ADMIT ONE LEARNER

**No. 2.11**

CLASS

**TECH-BASED**

PERIOD

**PERIOD 11**

DURATION

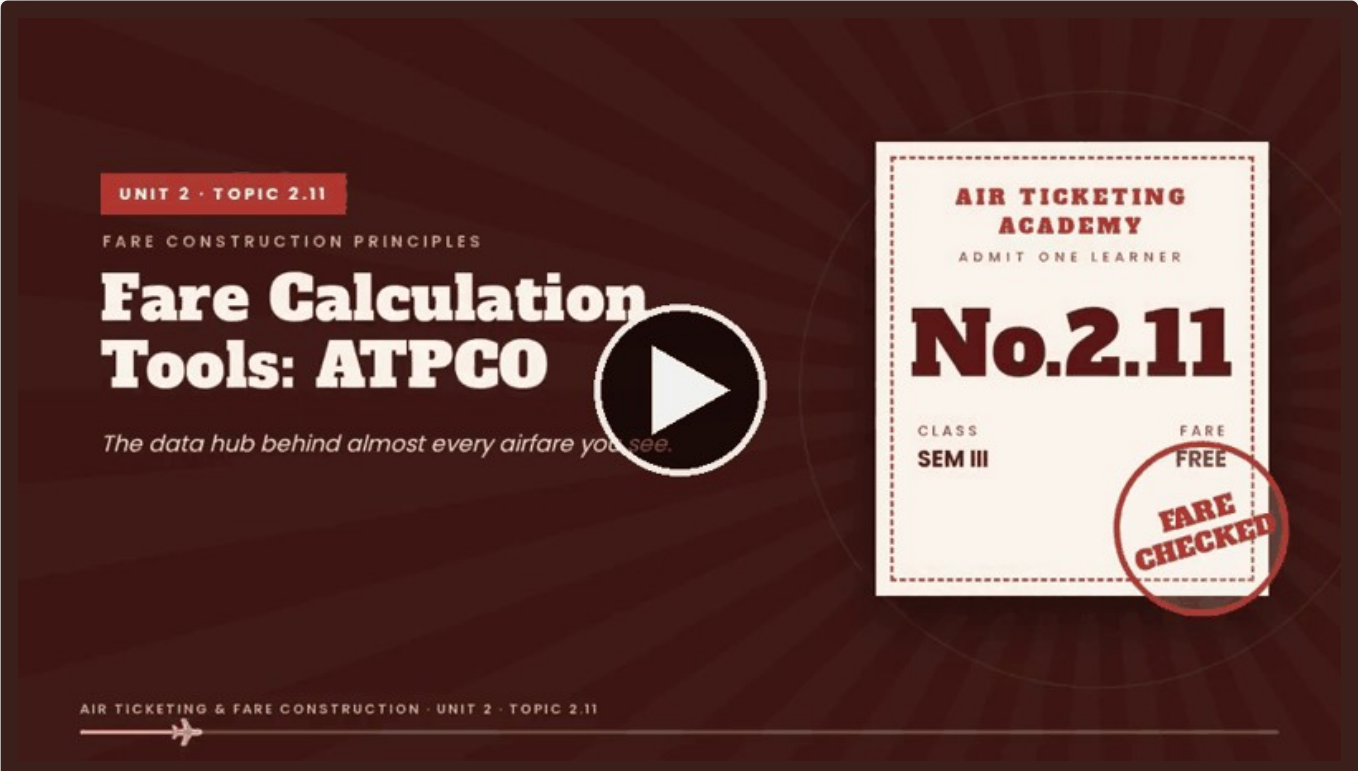
**40 MIN**

FARE

**FREE****FARE  
CHECKED**

- TOPIC 2.11

## Now Showing: Topic Intro



UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.11

FARE CONSTRUCTION PRINCIPLES

# Fare Calculation Tools: ATPCO

*The data hub behind almost every airfare you see.*

AIR TICKETING ACADEMY  
ADMIT ONE LEARNER

## No.2.11

CLASS SEM III

FARE FREE

**FARE CHECKED**

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Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 2: Fare Construction Principles · Topic 2.11

## ● TOPIC 2.11

## The Ticket Puzzle

**THINK ABOUT IT**

Who makes sure a new fare appears correctly on thousands of websites within an hour?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



## ● TOPIC 2.11

## Your Fare Itinerary

1

**2.11.1**

Introduction to ATPCO: how it sets and manages fares for airlines

2

**2.11.2**

Role of ATPCO in standardising and publishing fare structures

3

**2.11.3**

Key functions: fare filing, pricing and distribution of ticketing information

4

**2.11.4**

Case study: how ATPCO influences fare pricing in real scenarios

**BY THE END, YOU WILL**

- Explain what ATPCO is and who owns it
- Describe the fare filing and distribution cycle
- Identify ATPCO data products
- Trace a fare change from airline to customer

*Pedagogy: Technology-Based Learning*



- TOPIC 2.11.1

## ATPCO at a Glance

*Airline Tariff Publishing Company.*

**1965**

founded; owned by a group of airlines

**400+**

airlines file fares through ATPCO  
(approx.)

**Millions**

of fare changes processed every day



Important: ATPCO does not set prices itself — airlines decide fares; ATPCO collects, standardises and distributes them.



## ● TOPIC 2.11.1

## From Airline Decision to Your Screen



## ● TOPIC 2.11.2

## Why Standardisation Matters

**Common language**

Every airline's rules use the same category structure.

**Combinability**

Fares from different airlines can be combined on one ticket.

**Accurate pricing**

GDS engines price consistently worldwide.

**THINK**

Without ATPCO, every GDS would need a separate connection and format for each of hundreds of airlines — pricing an interline ticket would be almost impossible.



## ● TOPIC 2.11.3

## Key ATPCO Functions

**Fare Filing**

Fares, rules, routings and footnotes.

**Surcharges & Taxes**

Carrier charges (YQ/YR) and tax data.

**Optional Services**

Baggage allowances and ancillary fees.

**Branded Fares & Content**

Fare families and rich content (Routehappy).



**• TOPIC 2.11.3**

## Ticketing Information ATPCO Distributes



### Automated Reissue

Rules (Cat 31) let GDSs auto-price changes.



### Automated Refunds

Cat 33 data lets refunds be calculated automatically.



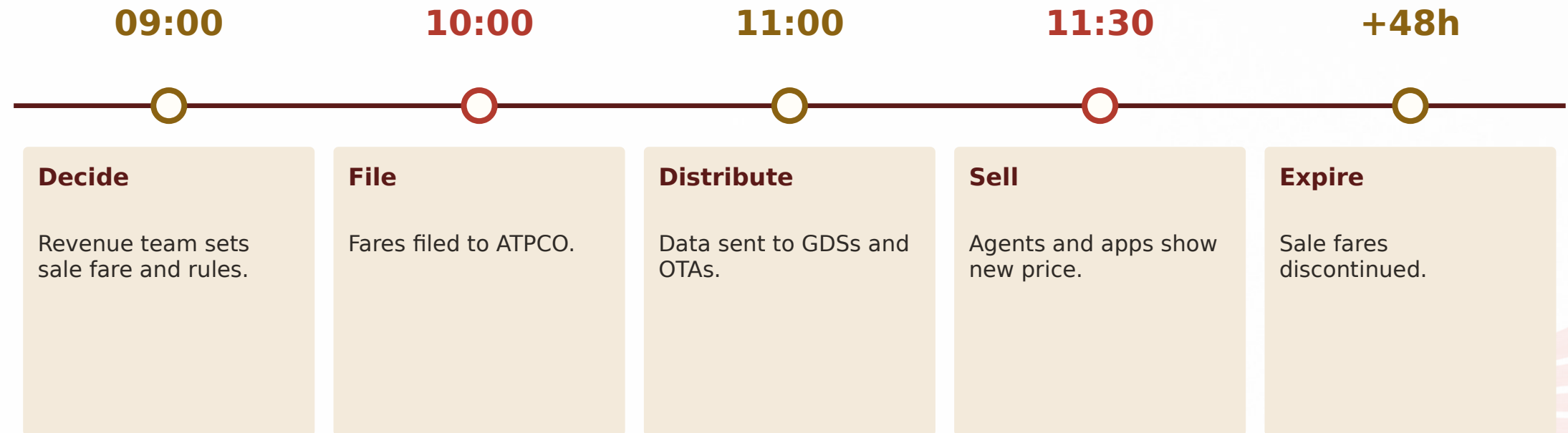
### NDC Support

Products that help airlines bridge filed fares and NDC offers.

## ● TOPIC 2.11.4

## Case Study: A Fare Sale Goes Live

*An airline launches a 48-hour sale on DEL-BKK (illustrative).*



## ● TOPIC 2.11.4

## Case Lessons



### When It Works

- Same price everywhere quickly
- Rules applied consistently
- Auto-reissue and refunds work

**VS**

### When It Goes Wrong

- Filing errors can create “mistake fares”
- Airline must decide whether to honour
- Agents must follow airline guidance



● TOPIC 2.11.4

## Tech Check

**Cat 5**

Advance purchase

**Cat 16**

Penalties

**Cat 31**

Voluntary changes

**Cat 35**

Negotiated fares



Explore: visit [atpco.net](https://atpco.net) and find one product or data service you did not know about.

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## Ticket Office Workshop: Follow the Fare

**PEDAGOGY****Technology-Based Learning****TIME · 10 min****FORMAT · Pairs with devices****1**

Browse the ATPCO website “what we do” section.

**2**

Draw the data flow from airline to OTA screen.

**3**

Identify which ATPCO category controls baggage, changes and refunds.

**4**

Share one surprising fact with the class.



## ● TOPIC 2.11

*Click to reveal each answer*

## Fare Check Quiz

**Q1****ATPCO stands for...**

- A) Air Transport Pricing Commission
- B) Airline Tariff Publishing Company
- C) Airport Ticketing Policy Council
- D) Air Travel Payment Company

**ANSWER****B****Q2****Who decides the fare amounts?**

- A) ATPCO
- B) The airlines
- C) IATA
- D) OTAs

**ANSWER****B****Q3****ATPCO is owned by...**

- A) Governments
- B) Airlines
- C) Travel agents
- D) Banks

**ANSWER****B****Q4****Automated refunds use data from...**

- A) Cat 3
- B) Cat 11
- C) Cat 33
- D) Cat 1

**ANSWER****C**

**TICKET STAMPED**

# Key Takeaways

- ✓ ATPCO collects and distributes airline fares; airlines set them
- ✓ Standard categories let fares be priced and combined worldwide
- ✓ Functions: filing, surcharges, baggage, branded fares, reissue/refund data
- ✓ Fast distribution makes fare changes live within hours

**EXIT TICKET** Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

**NEXT TICKET**

## Topic 2.12 — Farelogix: Managing Fare Rules and Pricing

**Thank you · Questions?**